

Preston Carey Leslie

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Dear Data and Performance Manager and Members of the Selection Committee,

I am writing to express my enthusiastic interest in the Temporary Data Analyst position supporting the Youth and Family Empowerment (YFE) Division. I am currently executing a self-funded, permanent relocation to the Seattle area and am completely free of local commitments, allowing me to establish immediate regional availability to hit the ground running for this six-month operational term. My professional focus centers on serving as an autonomous, systems-oriented data translator who builds reproducible analytical pipelines, designs rigid documentation frameworks, and protects data integrity within complex human service ecosystems.

The Human Services Department's mandate to center racial equity and social justice while utilizing data-driven performance metrics requires an analyst who respects both data sovereignty and database logic. I hold a Master of Science in Quantitative Methods and Modeling from Baruch College's Zicklin School of Business, equipping me with the mathematical foundations required to optimize data systems and audit complex data warehouses. This academic training is backed by five years of hands-on operations optimization and system triage within a highly regulated, multi-million-dollar community health network.

My background directly fulfills the operational requirements of the Data Performance and Evaluation (DPE) Team:

- **Data Quality, Validation, and Performance Tracking:** I specialize in developing agile data tracking systems where none exist to expose operational bottlenecks. When a rapid expansion of behavioral health providers over-saturated a small, 3-to-5-person frontline staff with a massive backlog of unquantified queue tasks, emails, and incoming calls, I engineered an ad-hoc performance-tracking infrastructure from scratch. By capturing daily task telemetry and auditing morning-to-evening data baselines, I provided leadership with the empirical proof needed to demonstrate capacity deficits. This data directly justified a new pilot call center program, where I subsequently trained team leads and stabilized the workflow pipeline.
- **Applied Analysis and Technical Troubleshooting:** My technical toolkit spans Python, R, and SQL, alongside extensive experience managing business intelligence dashboards in Tableau and Excel. Whether troubleshooting data ingestion scripts, executing multi-field deduplication routines, or constructing automated workflows, I focus on transforming messy data matrices into clear, actionable insights for diverse audiences. I am deeply comfortable authoring Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs) and maintaining data dictionaries to ensure long-term analytical reproducibility.
- **Equity-Centered Stakeholder Navigation:** As an elected 1199SEIU Union Delegate representing over 300 personnel, I collaborated directly with executive leadership to resolve grievances and interpret complex agreements within rigid civil compliance frameworks. Furthermore, my daily work at Callen-Lorde was dedicated to bridging system navigation gaps for trans and nonbinary individuals to ensure equitable access to care. I possess the emotional intelligence, level-headed composure, and cultural agility required to collaborate effectively across HSD divisions and respect the lived experiences behind the data points.

I am eager to apply my quantitative toolkit, process-automation focus, and passion for human services to the YFE portfolio. Thank you for your time, leadership, and consideration of my application.

Best regards,

Preston Carey Leslie

